VOLLEYBALL MANAGEMENT

CARD GAME

The strategic volleyball management game for 3–4 players

First player to reach 8 victory points wins!

Table of Contents

1. Game Overview 3
2. Game Setup 4
3. The Game Board 5
4. Event Spaces 6
5. Tournament Calendar 7
Champions League 8
6. League Matches 9
Round 2 – Position Poker 10
Round 3 – Action Chains & Libero 10
7. Transfers & Economy 11
8. End of Season & Scoring 12
9. Prize Money & Points Overview 13
10. Game Start Checklist 14

1. Game Overview

🏐 Players: 3–4 persons
🎯 Goal: Be the first to reach 8 victory points
💰 Starting capital: 80'000 per player
⏱️ Duration: approx. 90–150 min. per season

Each player manages a volleyball team, buys players via auctions and competes in league and tournaments for money and victory points. The game runs over multiple seasons (6 weeks each) until someone reaches 8 victory points.

Components

- Player cards: 1–5 stars | RED = Outside · GREEN = Middle · LIGHT BLUE = Setter · DARK BLUE = Diagonal · YELLOW = Libero
- Action cards with game-changing effects (effect shown on card)
- Banknotes: 20'000 / 10'000 / 5'000 units
- Dice: 3-sided, 6-sided and 12-sided
- Game board with 6-week timeline (+ optional week 7 for CL Final)
- Black hat as global time marker for all players

2. Game Setup

Step 1 – Starting Capital

Each player receives 80'000 from the bank.

Step 2 – Blind Draw

The youngest player starts. Each player draws from the face-down pile:

- 1× 4-star card
- 2× 3-star cards
- 3× 2-star cards

Afterwards each player consciously picks 3× 1-star cards by position.

REDRAW OPTION: If a player ends up with more than 3 cards of the same position after the blind draw, they may redraw completely.

Step 3 – Opening Auction (6 players)

All cards from 2–5 stars are shuffled to form the auction pile. 1-star cards remain separate and can be bought at any time at a fixed price (10'000).

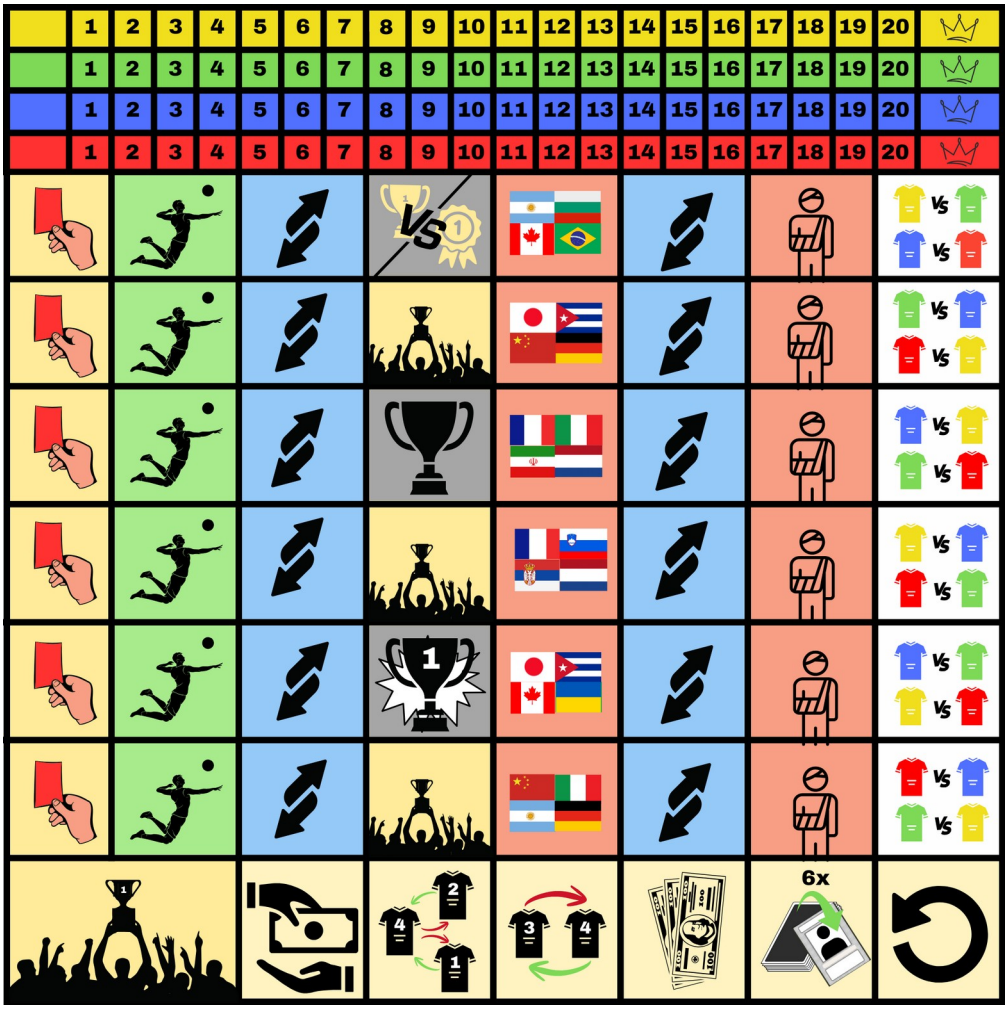
6 players are revealed and auctioned:

- Minimum bid: star value × 10'000 (e.g. 4 stars = minimum 40'000)
- The youngest player bids first, then clockwise

Step 4 – Determine Starting Player

All players roll the 12-sided die. Highest roll starts. Play continues clockwise.

3. The Game Board



The Black Hat

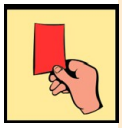
- There is only ONE hat – all players move the same hat
- Event spaces only affect the player who just rolled
- League (Day 8) and tournaments (Day 4) are played immediately when the hat passes them

Points Scale

Each player has a coloured scale on the game board for their league points within the season (win = +3, draw = +1). These league points determine the season ranking – not the victory points.

4. Event Spaces

When the black hat lands on an event space, it always affects the player who just rolled:



Red Card: Roll the 6-sided die to determine which of your 6 starting players is suspended. Suspension lasts until after the next league match.

Player Transfer: A new player from the auction pile is revealed and immediately auctioned. The triggering player may bid first.

Action Card: ALL players at the table (not just the roller) each take one action card from the pile. Effects are shown on the card.

National Team Games: All players on your team whose flag is shown are absent for the entire week due to VNL participation. They return after the league match.

Injury: Roll the 6-sided die to determine which of your 6 starting players is injured. Recovery after the next league match.

IMPORTANT – Best Line-up Rule:
At all event spaces, the best possible line-up must always be used. Substitute players may not be strategically 'sacrificed'!

5. Tournament Calendar

Woche	Tag	Event	Details
Week 1	Day 4	**Super Cup**	League Winer vs. Cup-Sieger (ab Saison 2)
Week 1–6	Day 8	**League Match**	Jede Woche, sobald Hütchen Day 8 überfährt
Week 2	Day 4	**Champions League**	Group stage (from season 2)
Week 3	Day 4	**Cup**	Semifinal – everyone rolls once
Week 4	Day 4	**Champions League**	Group stage (from season 2)
Week 5	Day 4	**Cup Final**	The 2 Cup winners play each other
Week 6	Day 4	**Champions League**	Group stage (from season 2)
Week 7 (opt.)	Day 4	**CL Final**	Nur wenn jemand das CL Final erreicht

Super Cup (ab Saison 2 · Week 1 / Day 4)

- Teilnehmer: League winner vs. Cup winner of last season (if same: League runner-up)
- Played using the classic system (home team rolls 4× with the 12-sided die)
- Prize money: 15'000 from the bank – winner only

Cup (Week 3 / Day 4)

- ALL eligible players each roll once with the 12-sided die
- The two highest rolls play each other, as do the next two
- Higher roll = home advantage in the Cup match
- Prize money: 20'000 from the bank
- Die zwei Sieger ziehen ins Cup Final ein

Cup Final (Week 5 / Day 4)

- The two Cup winners play each other
- Winner: 2 victory points | 2nd place: 1 victory point

Champions League (from Season 2 · Weeks 2, 4, 6)

- Participants: League winner + Cup winner (if same: League runner-up)
- Home advantage: Real player = always home team. If both real: roll, higher wins
- CL team cards are shuffled. Every 2 revealed cards form a pair
- Without a real player: star comparison – weaker team is eliminated
- With a real player: Classic system with 12-sided die
- CL teams do NOT rotate. Only real player teams rotate normally
- Preisgeld: 20'000 pro Vorrunden-Sieg | 25'000 für CL Final-Sieg
- In season 1: CL spaces are simply passed – nothing happens

6. League Matches

League Matche finden immer an Day 8 statt, sobald das Hütchen diese Linie überfährt. Die Farbe links vorne im Liga-Kästchen ist immer Heimteam.

💰 Money: Winner receives 10'000 (bank) + 5'000 (loser)
📊 Liga-Punkte: Sieg = +3 | Unentschieden = +1 auf der Points Scale
🎰 3 players: Player without a match receives 5'000 bye from the bank

Round 1 - Classic System (Season 1)

The home team rolls 4× with the 12-sided die. Each roll is evaluated immediately. Whoever wins a point must rotate.

#	Criterion	Rule
1	Total team	Most total stars wins
2	Front attackers	Stronger 3 cards in the front row
3	Back defenders	Stronger 3 cards in the back row
4	Dice comparison	Higher dice roll wins
5	Middle blocker	Besserer vorderer Middle blocker gewinnt
6	Serve	Home (back right) vs. Away Libero. If Libero serves: Middle must step in
7	Diagonal + Setter	Compare Diagonal + Setter of both teams
8	Outside back vs. Diagonal	Compare outside attacker back row against diagonal
9	12-sided die roll	Home rolls 12-sided. Roll > stars (Middle+Outside Away) = Home. Stars > roll = Away. Equal = nobody
10	Crunch Time	+2 additional rolls in this match
11	Injury	Roll 12-sided: 1–6 = home player, 7–12 = away player affected. Number = position (1=back right...). Out for the rest of the match
12	Money Rain	Both teams each receive 5'000 from the bank

Round 2 – Position Poker (Season 2)

Each team receives 6 position cards (Outside front, Outside back, Diagonal, Setter, Libero, Middle) and forms 3 pairs in order 1–3. Both reveal pair by pair. Whoever has more stars in the pair wins the point and rotates.

> Tactic: The same player can appear in two pairs – e.g. Outside front + Outside back after rotation.

Round 3 – Action Chains (Season 3)

There are 3 rounds. In each round both teams simultaneously roll 3× with the 6-sided die. The stars of the rolled players are added up. More stars = point won. Whoever wins a point must rotate.

> Special rule: If the same player is rolled 2× in a row → ball drops – point lost!

From season 4 onward the cycle restarts: Classic → Poker → Action Chains → ...

Libero & Rotation

Wenn nach Rotation der Middle blocker in die hintere Zone wechselt, kommt der Libero rein. Der Middle blocker verlässt das Feld für 3 Rotationen, dann wechselt die 2. Mitte wieder heraus.

> Team requirement: At least 7 players needed – 6 field players (incl. Libero) + a 2nd middle.
> The Libero CANNOT be replaced by a field player!

7. Transfers & Economy

Buying Players

- 1-star: Available at any time at a fixed price of 10'000
- 2–5 stars: Only available via auction (when revealed)

Selling Players

- Any player can be sold at any time for HALF their star value
- Example: 3-star player = 15'000

Player Swap

- Tradeable 1:1 between players at any time
- Or for an agreed monetary amount

Auction Process (during the game)

- The first to bid opens the auction
- All others may then bid clockwise

8. End of Season & Scoring

Step 1 – Player Elimination

Each player protects one player (face down). Then dice are rolled: the rolled position must return their player to the pile. The team is not refilled.

Step 2 – Swap & Steal Phase

- Position 4 may steal one card of the same position from positions 1 and 2 (swap worse for better)
- Position 3 may steal one card of the same position from position 4
- Only possible if there is a positive swap – otherwise no swap

Step 3 – New Auction

6 new players are revealed and auctioned. Position 4 bids first.

9. Übersicht Preisgelder & Victory Points

Event	Money	Victory Points
League Win	10'000 (bank) + 5'000 (loser)	–
League Draw	5'000 (bank)	–
Cup Semifinal Win	20'000 (bank)	–
Cup Final Sieger	–	2 Punkte
Cup Final 2ter	–	1 Punkt
Super Cup Sieger	15'000 (bank)	–
CL Group Stage Win	20'000 (bank)	–
CL Final Sieger	25'000 (bank)	–
End of Season 1st Place	0	3 Punkte
End of Season 2nd Place	20'000	2 Punkte
End of Season 3rd Place	30'000	1 Punkt
End of Season 4th Place	50'000	0 Punkte
Bye (3 players only)	5'000 (bank)	–

10. Game Start Checklist

- ☐ Each player receives 80'000
- ☐ Youngest draws blind: 1× 4-star, 2× 3-star, 3× 2-star
- ☐ All players pick 3× 1-star cards by desired position
- ☐ Check redraw option (more than 3 same positions?)
- ☐ Reveal and auction 6 players
- ☐ Roll 12-sided die to determine who starts
- ☐ Place black hat on starting position
- ☐ Assign board colours
- ☐ Let's go! 🏐

Have fun playing!